

Florian Strauf

florian@learnedlate.com | [Twitter](#) | [LinkedIn](#) | [GitHub](#) | Location: New Zealand

SUMMARY

Solution Architect & AI Strategist | SAP BTP · Business AI · LLM Systems

Senior solution architect with deep SAP DNA and 20+ years designing, architecting, and delivering enterprise software. Recent focus on LLM/RAG systems, agentic workflows, and production AI pipelines. Combines strategic board-level advisory with hands-on engineering credibility to integrate modern AI into complex SAP/ERP environments.

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

- **Forward deployed delivery & use-case discovery** — embed with clients to understand business problems, scope opportunities, and build them into concrete engineering deliverables.
- **Rapid prototyping & production validation** — move quickly from idea to working prototype, validate with real users, and iterate toward a production-ready system.
- **Solution architecture & pragmatic build decisions** — design architectures that fit the client's environment, assess build-vs-buy and custom options, and integrate modern AI with existing ERP/systems-of-record.
- **AI/ML systems in production** — build and operate LLM-powered features, RAG pipelines, embeddings, vector stores, and agentic workflows with appropriate guardrails and oversight.
- **Technical leadership & delivery enablement** — lead engineering teams, improve development processes, and raise execution quality without slowing delivery.
- **Stakeholder communication & knowledge transfer** — work credibly with engineering, data, security, and business stakeholders, and hand over live systems with clear documentation and runbooks.
- **Hands-On Technical Depth:** Credible across architecture and implementation, from enterprise integrations and backend systems to frontend applications, data pipelines, and analytics.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Solution Architect at SAP

2014 - 2021

Progressed through senior solution architect roles, delivering complex enterprise solutions across industries while shaping customer advisory and board-level innovation initiatives.

- **Solution Architect, Custom Development (2020–2021):** Senior Solution Architect in the SAP Centre of Excellence, connecting customer requirements to solution architecture, roadmap planning, and product extension strategy for Intelligent Asset Management.
- **Board-level innovation leadership (2021):** Shaped SAP's strategy for emerging AI-adjacent and decentralised technologies; built board-level proposals on crypto payments, token-based revenue models, and supply-chain carbon use cases across the German automotive industry, including Catena-X and Gaia-X.
- **Enterprise client delivery:** Served as trusted advisor to Fortune Global 100 / Fortune 500 organisations, including APM Terminals, Port of Hamburg, and Port of Singapore, owning solution architecture from concept through production and support handover.

- **Innovation & proof-of-concepts:** As part of SAP's innovation team, built proof-of-concepts with enterprise customers that integrated modern technologies into their existing infrastructure. With the Port of Rotterdam, rapidly developed and demonstrated value that supported a large deal and helped win the contract.
- **Applied technology innovation (2014-2020):** Led technical delivery teams from PoC to live production cloud environments, specialising in IoT, spatial/mapping integrations, data-driven architectures, and custom SAP extensions.
- **Delivery excellence:** Led cloud customers out of escalation by analysing and improving system performance; recognised with SAP Catalyst / Fast Track awards in 2016, 2017, 2018, and 2019.
- **Bridge to SAP Business AI:** Subsequent AI engineering experience (LLM/RAG, agentic workflows, production pipelines) positions me to architect SAP's Business AI and Joule integrations.

AI Consulting Practice — [LearnedLate](#)

Forward Deployed AI Engineer | March 2025 - Present

Deliver LLM implementations and ArcGIS integrations for enterprise clients, from discovery through production handover.

- Built and run an agentic SEO workflow that automates keyword research, content generation, cannibalisation checks, publishing, and iteration across owned and client sites — currently driving 600,000+ search impressions and thousands of organic clicks with no ad spend.
- Use Rust (rig) and Python AI pipelines as a live environment for testing RAG, retrieval tuning, content operations automation, and practical build-vs-custom decisions.
- Supported solution architecture for New Zealand Packing and Kiwifruit Management Company, assessing ERP direction and integration trade-offs, and delivered a production-ready ArcGIS integration that mapped complex spatial data into core business workflows.
- Run structured discovery, rapid prototyping, implementation, and handover for client engagements, with clear documentation and runbooks for ongoing support.

Builder at [daystoexpiry.com](#)

2025 - Present

Built and operate a niche SaaS product from concept to paying customers, iterating continuously based on early-user feedback.

- Built a production data pipeline that ingests and parses broker statements, normalises positions and trades, and presents an options-focused portfolio view.
- Implemented a RAG system over podcast and market knowledge using Pydantic AI, embeddings, and vector storage in Postgres, so users can retrieve relevant market sentiment and educational content for their specific trade scenarios.
- Delivered AI-assisted trade discovery for covered calls, put selling, and other income strategies, with guardrails, scoped permissioning, and an audit log of recommendations.
- Shipped Rust (rig) workflows for sentiment processing and retrieval-backed analysis, integrated into a full-stack TypeScript/Vue application with CI/CD and production monitoring.

CTO at [Forgd.com](#)

Jan 2024 - March 2025

Led technical vision and delivery of the Forgd platform from concept to 1,000+ users in under 12 months, growing the team from 4 to 14 engineers. Introduced AI-assisted development workflows and owned architecture, release governance, and production support.

Tokenomics DAO (acquired by Forgd.com)

2021 - 2024

Built and led a 3,000-member consulting community and token-launch SaaS for modelling supply/demand curves, running the business through acquisition by Forgd.com.

Development Consultant at SER Solutions Deutschland GmbH

2005 - 2014

Progressed from apprentice to Development Consultant, specialising in SAP ABAP development, workflow architecture, and enterprise content management integrations.

- **SAP FI/MM invoice processing (2012-2014):** Architected and developed FI/MM invoice-processing workflow solutions, delivered UX with SAP Fiori, SAPUI5, and OData, and built Web Dynpro ABAP and NetWeaver Portal solutions.
- **Product management / quality management (2008-2012):** Led internal consulting projects on J2EE application servers (JBoss, IBM WebSphere) and managed migration of existing customers to the latest product generation.
- **Apprenticeship (2005-2008):** Completed apprenticeship as Development Consultant with project development across .NET, Java, and Visual Basic.

EDUCATION

- **Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.),** FOM University of Applied Sciences for Economics and Management, Köln/Bonn, Germany (2014)
- **Apprenticeship as Development Consultant,** IHK Germany (2008)

ADDITIONAL ACTIVITIES

- **Writing:** Over 2,300 readers follow my writing at [LearnedLate](#).